

BERNERA NEWS

By the community, for the community 
in association with

WHAT'S ON

Bernera Film Club

Bernera Community Centre

Friday 21st April, Snacks from 7.00pm, Film at 8pm

Film club membership £5, New members welcome.

With the turn of the season, some things are opening and others are closing

Bernera Cafe. Open Tuesday, 12-3pm. From the 2nd May the cafe will be open on Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday.

Bernera Community Shop. Monday to Friday, 12-3pm. Well stocked with groceries and a selection of local crafts.

Soup Stop. Open on Thursdays 12-2pm until 4th May. In the Community Centre Cafe, come along for a free soup, hot drinks and a blether – all welcome.

Forage Honesty Shop @ Kirkibost. Open 24/7. Sells eggs, bread, Scottish produce, sweets and some essential items.

The Wee Gift Box @ 8 Breacleite. Open 24/7. Sells handmade souvenirs & gifts and a selection of children's toys/games.

Correction to last months **What's On**: There is no Badminton Club on a Thursday eve.



SAFE FAMILIES WESTERN ISLES

Safe Families Western Isles is a local charity that supports families going through difficult times. This support is given by trained volunteers who are keen to support their community; and can support a family by being the parent's befriender, a helper and befriender to their children, and/or by offering overnight stays at their own home so that the family can have a break.

Safe Families Western Isles will support families who have a child/children within the ages of 3-15, and there are no limits on who can refer a family to us. This includes social workers, health visitors, GPs, schools etc. We also take self-referrals. For more information, please contact us on **01851 827308**, or e-mail **westernisles@safefamilies.uk**.

UNUSED COMPUTERS?

Do you have any unused or unwanted technology like laptops, tablets or phones that could use a new home, rather than lying, disused in a drawer? We can collect them, refurbish them and pass them on to community members who may not have access to such items.

Contact the Bernera News Team:

Julia **07894 516 609** | julia@croft22.co.uk or Nat **07831 690 547** | nat@croft22.co.uk

PENNY'S PLANTINGS

I have written this before, but my ancient pc decided to wipe it as I was talking about rats. Just a friendly warning, that rats, are on the move and breeding like crazy. If you are feeding the birds or have any corn or whatever in bags then put everything in bins. This encourages them to look elsewhere for food. Using a spray of one part household Ammonia to five parts water, not only keeps rats away, but you can keep away slugs and snails as they too start to make an appearance.

Gardening of any kind has been difficult in the snow and ice which hopefully is behind us now, But as the old saying goes "Ne'er cast a clout till May is out". This is about Vests, but works well for frosts too. We can still get a frost right into May. So though the garden centres are full of glorious colour of new plants, have caution on getting these out in the garden. By all means buy them, but put in a green house or polygrub until the danger has past. It's all a bit early for planting out. You may get away with early Polyanthus in pots in a sheltered place or even a few Violas, however, just be careful as there is nothing worse than seeing all your hard work, turned crisp and brown from a hard frost.

I am as always thrilled when the first leaves appear in the garden, my Hawthorn is always first, bright verdant leaves amongst the seemingly ever bare branches. The Evergreens too sprout new bright greens amongst the old dark green and the Elderflowers are coming, carefully, slowly. If you have Buddleia, now is the time to prune back half the growth, any branches crossing... a general tidy up. It will appreciate it and show much more growth. If you are really brave, cut back to last years nub, we used to do this further south, cut right back to the old wood. It always grew back bigger and better. Here, I'm not so brave, as the growing season is much shorter and Buddleias are late flowering plants. The same really goes with any flowering shrub, but cut back before the sap in the plant starts rising. Other wise you will kill it. I do most of my cutting back in winter, but some old gardeners say cutback Apple trees in Summer. For me this is too risky if the fruit is already forming.

Plums of any kind don't like pruning at all. If you are reckless enough to do it, the plum will reward you with new growth but no fruit for a few years. Plums are a bit cantankerous this way. Alan and I did some coppicing this Autumn in my trees, and so I have some Long willow poles if anyone wants them for fencing or even bean poles. Just contact me if you want them or just come and help yourself, they are on the ground by the drive gate. If you want them for fencing poles, remember they are willow and will grow if left in the ground.

Now I know a lot of people don't like Gorse, but I do, for a starter in Hedging. My gorse has been in flower the whole of this winter without fail, its bright yellow flowers cheering me up whatever the weather has been doing. However Gorse needs control, and when it stops flowering it will get cut back to a quarter of its size. If I can find some seedlings, I will pull them up and pot them. Let me know if you want any. If you keep cutting back gorse it will never get untidy. Don't forget to NOT, clear away old leaves and garden detritus until may, as bumble bees nest in this as do Hover flies, Bee Flies, beetles and other useful pollinators. In May you can have a good old clear out of old growth, and fallen leaves.

Penny Spinks
Hacklete



FORAGE CROFT HONESTY SHOP

We are stocking eco cleaning bags which will include environmentally and allergen friendly products as part of the **GBCDT Cost of Living Support scheme**. Any one interested can collect one free of charge from Forage Croft Shop.

This scheme is for residents of Bernera and Tir Mor. If you can't make it to the shop please text your details to Julia on 07894516609 and one will be delivered to you without cost.

We are pleased to be able to support this scheme to help ease household budgets which are being stretched so far.



GREAT BERNERA
– Community Development Trust –

APRIL UPDATE

The trust is delighted to have been able to extend the contracts of our 2 part time, development trust officers, Joanna George and Nat Higginbottom for a further year, until 31st March 2024. They have been instrumental in getting some new initiatives and partnerships working across the island. Ranging from the social isolation and cost of living support, to supporting local groups and subsidising petrol at the BCA pumps. In addition, the stage 2 funding application for the Hatchery has been submitted and we should have an answer by the end of May.



After the last AGM, with some extra trustees and volunteers stepping forward, we have now got a stronger team, to help the development officers to deliver the Trust's core remit to buy the island for the community and to engage in helping to make it sustainable.

10% Community Shop Discount

Every Tuesday and Thursday, Bernera Community Shop will be offering a 10% discount off all products to all Bernera and Tir Mor residents. (This offer starts on the 7th March).

Complimentary 'Essentials Bags'

To help with the rising cost of living, beginning on the Friday the 17th of March, each fortnightly Friday we're giving away complimentary bags of essential household products (toiletries and cleaning products worth £20). The bags (one per household) will be distributed through Bernera Community Shop (Breaclete) and Forage (22 Kirkibost). For more information, please keep your eye on the Great Bernera Community Development Trust Facebook page, BCA Bernera Community Association Facebook page or Croft 22 - Farm, Forage, Feast & Forest Facebook page, or just head over to the shops themselves.

CnES COST OF LIVING FUNDING

The Trust are pleased to announce an additional £2500 of funding from CnES which will go towards the communities existing cost-of-living support. The funding will go towards the continued provision of items aimed at helping Bernera residents to stay warm in their homes. If you are elderly, infirm or living in a cold property/ struggling with heating bills, then please do get in touch. Items include oil heaters, electric throws and robes, coal and logs. For more information, please contact Jo (Bernera Trust) at jo@greatbernera.org or enquire with a member of staff at Breaclete shop.

SOUP STOP

The Soup Stop will be ending for the season on the 4th May. The BCA cafe will then be open for its summer hours, and the Soup Stop will resume again in October. We are most grateful to our funders DTAS and TSI, and all the local volunteers and soup makers for enabling us to provide this community service. Thank you



TRI TAIRBH IS BÒ



Chan e sgeulachd cheart a thai, ach cuid de cuimhneachain ceangailte ris na beathaichean seo. Feumaidh mi ag radh nach eil cuimhne sam bith agam air a' chiad tachartas oir bha mi nam leanaban fhathast.

Aon latha bha mo mhàthair is mi fhìn a'dhol dhan Bhaile ach bha cabhag oirre am bus fhaighinn. Mar sin cha deach i air an rathad leis a' phram ach ghabh i frith-rathad tron achadh an àite. Cha robh fios aice gun robh tarbh anns an achadh. Gu fortanach bha e fad' air falbh agus cha do mhòtaich e sinn gus an do ràinig mo mhàthair an geata. Gu h-obann thiosich e à

ruith dar n-ionnsaigh. Ghabh mo mhàthair greim orm is shreap i thar a'gheata cho luath 's a b'urrainn dhi, a'cur cùl ris a' phram, is sinn sàbhailte.

B'e an ath choinneamh a bh'agam ri tarbh nuair a bha me dìreach ait toiseachadh san sgoil. Mar as trice choisich mo mhàthair còmhla rium gu taigh charaidean far an d'fhuair mi lioft dhan sgoil. Aig an latha àraidh seo bha uisge trom ann is cha deach i ach seachad air an achadh le crodh, oir bha tarbh nam measg. Choisich mi leam fhìn chun an taigh àbhaisteach, ach bha mi fadalach is bha an càr air falbh. Thionn daidh mi agus choisich mi dhachaigh a-rithist. Bha na beathaichean uile nan seasamh aig an fheansa ri fàsgadh nan craobhan. Cha robh trioblaid ann leis an tarbh an turas seo.

Chuir e iongnadh air mo mhàthair nuair a nochd mi anns a' chidsin bog-fliuch. Cha robh i toilichte g h-àraidh gun robh mi air coiseachd leam fhìn seachad air an tarbh.



Thachair mi ris an treas tarbh beagan bliadhnachan air ais ann an Eilean Chearrara nuair a bha mi a' coiseachd dhan Caisteal Gylen. Air an t-slighe ann chunnaic mi tarbh Gaidhealach glè mhòr na laighe air a' bhraighe - coltach ri rìgh air a rìgh chathair. Sheall e oirnn gu pròiseil ach cha do ghluais e òirleach! An tarbh as fheàrr a-riamh!

A-nis beagan bhriathran mun bà.

Thachair seo anns an Ostair nuair a chaidh sinn air cuairt air an duthaich. Chòrd e rinn a bhith a'coiseachd tro achaidhean agus thairis air cnuic Iàn each, caorach is cruaidh. Bha sinn dìreach a' fàgail an achadh agus a' dol thar an "stile" nuair a ruith bò sìos an cnoc agus thilg i aon d'ar caraidhean thar an fheansa. Taing do Dhìà cha robh i air a goirteachadh ged a dh'fhàg na h-adharcan bruthaidhean.

Nur beachd dè am beathach a bu mhiosa?

Linne NicLeòid
Dun Innes



THE CROFTING COMMISSION IS RECRUITING!

We are currently recruiting Crofting Area Representatives, formerly known as Crofting Assessors.

We are looking for enthusiastic volunteers from within the crofting counties to act as a valued link between the Commission and local crofting communities. Full training and support will be provided to help support crofting in your area.

Please apply via our website at www.crofting.scotland.gov.uk

BOSTA IRON AGE HOUSE AND BERNERA MUSEUM 2023 OPENING



This year the Iron Age House at Bosta will have slightly longer opening than for the last few summers that we have been open, which includes two weeks over Easter.

We are also pleased to welcome Paul Macaulay as the main guide following the retirement of Elizabeth at the end of last season. Paul will be assisted by Ian Mackay and Colin Halliday, mainly on Saturdays during the summer and at busy times with tour groups, there are already 27 groups booked in mainly from cruise ships. We have held the entrance costs for both again this year, and remember that residents of Bernera and Tir Mor get in free.

Iron Age House opening times

3rd to 14th April, Monday to Friday 12 noon to 4pm

Then

1st May to 29th September Monday to Friday 12 noon to 4pm and Saturday 12 noon to 4pm June, July and August.

Entrance is £4 per head and £1 for children under 12.

Bernera Museum opening times

1st May to 29th September Monday to Friday 12 noon to 4pm

Entrance is £2 per head and free for children under 12.

Our guides at the house and volunteers at the museum are looking forward to seeing you during this summer season.

If you have any queries please email the museum on **berneramuseum1@gmail.com**, including out of normal opening hours.



Colin Halliday
Kirkibost

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ ANSWERS

- | | | |
|---------------|------------|--------------|
| 1. Hamlet | 12. Table | 23. Post |
| 2. Thatcher | 13. Watch | 24. Slip |
| 3. Beefeater | 14. Jog | 25. Quad |
| 4. Penguin | 15. Hot | 26. Minister |
| 5. Robin Hood | 16. Sign | 27. Aerial |
| 6. Pop | 17. Shift | 28. Duck |
| 7. Toll | 18. Fan | 29. Zodiac |
| 8. Trunk | 19. Eye | 30. Bench |
| 9. Shark | 20. Bale | |
| 10. Mouse | 21. Labour | |
| 11. Orange | 22. Change | |

Colin Halliday
Kirkibost



WHY?

Why is this happening to me? Why is my life so hard? Why am I the only one who has to face this day after day? A seemingly, unending providence without respite.

Perhaps you have thoughts like this yourself. Not theoretical possibility but a very real, daily, ongoing experience.

In seeking to be comforted, let us consider what happened in America over 222 years ago, when a young man called Conrad Reed discovered a 7.7kg rock while out fishing one day. Unaware of what it was made of, the Reed family used it as a doorstep for three years.

It was only after a trip to the Jewellers by his father, John Reed, that this functional lump of metal was in fact identified to be a lump of gold. Worth, in today's money, millions of pounds, yet for 3 years, the worth of this lump of gold was appreciated simply for its utility as a doorstep. It possessed so much more potential, so much more worth. Yet it was only when its composition was discerned, that its true value became known.

Likewise, until the composition of our faith is revealed, it's need of, and hope in Jesus remains hidden. This is why God allows trials into our lives. Not to hurt us, but to strengthen our hope in Himself. As Paul, tells us, by God's grace, **'we also glory in tribulations, knowing that tribulation produces perseverance; and perseverance, character; and character, hope'**, Rom 5:3-4

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



BERNERA BAKES... COCONUT LEMON LOAF

Loaf:

16oz S.R. flour
16oz margarine
16oz caster sugar
4oz coconut
2 lemon (grated rind only)
8 eggs
4 tablespoons milk

Topping:

8 tablespoons caster sugar
2 lemon (juice only)
Coconut for sprinkling

Method:

1. Heat oven to 180°C / 350°F.
2. Grease 2 x 2 lb loaf tin.
3. Sift all dry ingredients together, add margarine (cut into small pieces), rub margarine between fingertips until mixture resembles breadcrumbs.
4. Add beaten eggs, lemon rind & milk mixing well.
5. Spoon mixture into prepared tin & smooth level.
6. Bake for 45 mins until golden brown & firm to the touch.
7. Cool in tin for 5 mins.
8. Mix together the lemon juice & caster sugar, turn cake out of tin & stand on plate, slowly spoon the lemon juice mixture over the cake allowing it to soak in. Sprinkle the cake with the coconut.



Careen MacLennan
Kirkibost

